

JOSEPH WAKABA NJUGUNA

Culinary professional

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Management | À La Carte & Buffet Service | Saucier Station | HACCP Compliance | Inventory & Yield Testing | Menu Planning | Kitchen Supervision | Meat Fabrication | Poultry & Fish Butchery | Cost Control | Stock Rotation | Chiller Management | Team Training | BEO Coordination | Purchaser Liaison | Quality Assurance | High-Volume Production

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Culinary Professional with over **5 years of experience** in high-volume kitchens, including dedicated butchery roles. Proven ability to manage **butchery operations** – from receiving and inspecting meat, fish & poultry to yield testing, portion control, and daily market lists. Strong background in à la carte and buffet service within 3-star and 4-star hotels. Skilled in supervising kitchen staff, maintaining HACCP and hygiene standards, and liaising with outlet chefs and purchasers to ensure quality, minimise wastage, and maintain consistency. Actively contributes to menu development and BEO meetings.

CAREER STRENGTHS

- **Butchery & Meat Preparation** – Expert in breaking down red meats, poultry, and fish; yield testing; proper aging of red meats; maintaining chillers and rotation of product.
- **HACCP & Food Safety** – Enforces hygiene compliance, storage standards, and spoilage prevention; personally, inspects all incoming butchery items for quality.
- **Inventory & Cost Control** – Completes daily market lists based on hotel volume; ensures portion control to minimise wastage; manages storeroom requisitions.
- **Menu & Recipe Development** – Actively shares ideas to improve menus; ensures consistency in butchery items for à la carte and buffet according to property recipes.
- **Team Leadership & Communication** – Supervises Demi and Commis Chefs; liaises daily with outlet chefs, attends BEO meetings, and adjusts culinary BEOs.
- **Guest & Colleague Focus** – Strives for guest feedback; maintains and improves colleague cafeteria food offerings.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cook – Buffet & À La Carte | Mar 2025 – Present

Sentrim Hotels Limited (4-Star) – Nairobi

Key Contributions:

- Supervises kitchen team, delegates tasks according to mise en place lists, ensuring smooth workflow during high-volume buffet and à la carte service.
- Controls cooking procedures and presentation – portioning, garnishing, plating – maintaining consistent quality for international guests.
- Manages inventory and product turnover with daily stock checks and storage inspections, minimising food waste and reducing costs.
- Assists in menu planning and recipe development, collaborating with senior chefs to enhance menu diversity.
- Enforces HACCP and personal hygiene standards across all shifts, ensuring regulatory compliance.

Cook – Saucier | Mar 2022 – Feb 2025

Nokras Hotels Kenya (3-Star) – Nairobi

Key Contributions:

- Managed saucier station, preparing sauces and hot entrées to order, ensuring consistent quality.
- Supervised Demi and Commis Chefs on hygiene, cooking procedures, and plating standards, improving team performance.
- Assisted in recipe and menu creation, collaborating on new dishes and plating techniques.
- Maintained ingredient quality and storage, checking freshness and controlling preparation techniques to reduce spoilage.
- Coordinated cross-department communication with F&B outlets and service teams for seamless service.

Assistant Butcher Chef | Sep 2021 – Mar 2022

Talisman Restaurant – Nairobi

Key Contributions:

- Assisted in daily butchery operations: breaking down red meats, poultry, and fish for à la carte menus.
- Ensured proper portion control and minimised wastage through accurate cutting and trimming.
- Maintained cleanliness and rotation of product in butchery chillers, following HACCP guidelines.
- Liaised with purchasers to communicate quality-for-money ratio and inspected incoming meat, fish & poultry for hygiene and quality standards.
- Conducted yield testing on various cuts and assisted in daily market lists based on restaurant volume.
- Supported inventory management of red meats to ensure proper aging and freshness.

Chef de Partie – Butcher (formerly Kitchen Assistant – Vegetable Prep) | 2019

Marmu Restaurant – Nairobi

Key Contributions:

- Prepared bulk vegetables and legumes using standardized methods, ensuring timely readiness for daily service.
- Maintained hygiene and storage standards, preventing spoilage and ensuring food safety compliance.

Kitchen Assistant – À La Carte | 2020 – 2021

Marmu Restaurant – Nairobi

Key Contributions:

- Prepared mise en place and plated dishes – portioning, saucing, arranging – improving service speed and consistency.
- Supported supervision of junior staff, guiding Commis Chefs in workflow and hygiene practices.
- Maintained recipe consistency by following standard recipes and portioning guidelines.
- Ensured food safety compliance in storage and hygiene practices.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (Hotel & Restaurant Management) | 2019 – 2022

The Technical University of Kenya

PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- HACCP Knowledge – Certified

- High School Certificate
 - Culinary school training (included in degree)
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LANGUAGES

- English – Proficient
 - Swahili – Native
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REFERENCES

Available upon request